

Brattleboro Quilting Circle

The Log Cabin Block

A plain walkthrough for the winter throw, by Phil Lane

What we are making

- A log cabin throw, 8 blocks across by 6 down, 48 blocks.
- Palette: cream, barn red, pine green, ochre centers.
- A classic block, beginner friendly, endlessly variable.
- Full plan and yardage in the project notes, D07 and workbook X10.

The idea of the block

- A small center square stands for the hearth, traditionally ochre.
- Strips, the logs, build out around it round by round.
- Light fabrics on two adjacent sides, dark on the other two.
- Set every block the same way and the quilt reads light and dark diagonals.

Cutting list per block

Piece	Fabric	Size
Center	Ochre	2.5 inch square
Logs, light	Cream muslin	1.5 inch strips
Logs, dark	Barn red, pine green	1.5 inch strips
Finished block	All	8.5 inch square

Accuracy lives in the cutting and the pressing.

Order of work

- Cut centers and first logs, then chain piece in batches of eight.
- Add each log, press it out before the next; do not skip the pressing.
- Square every block to 8.5 inches before joining.
- Join into rows, then rows into the top, alternating seam directions.
- Layer with batting and flannel backing, baste, and quilt.

Finishing and care

- Quilt simple straight lines through the logs; keep it humble.
- Bind in the barn red to frame the whole piece.
- Label the back with the name and year.
- Wash cold and gentle, dry low; store out of direct sun.
- A handmade quilt, cared for, outlives the hands that made it.